Wayne Kim

Interaction Designer

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I research, then build: working prototypes, hardware and software, tested with people before teams commit. Seven years in design research at Designit and startups backed by a16z, YC, and SoftBank, then a Master's in Interaction Design at CIID.

EXPERIENCE

Independent | Interaction Designer
Sept 2025 - Present

Los Angeles, CA

- Building calm tech prototypes for the home: Toilet Paper Elevator and room_tone.
- Learning SolidWorks with cleantech startups at LACI.
- Two client projects with CIID, for a medical technology company and an AI translation company, under NDA.

Glorify | Senior Design Researcher
Feb 2023 - Feb 2024

Los Angeles, CA

- After the Series B, turned leadership's doubts about community into one testable hypothesis, then ran a 2-week prototype diary study with 82 people in their real small groups. 65% were still active at week two.
- Turned the findings into three design principles and presented them at the leadership offsite. Leadership launched Glorify Groups and committed 3 of 4 pods; it now has 1.8M+ users and 20% of daily actives.
- Built the research practice and grew the team from one researcher to three.

Designit | Design Researcher
Aug 2021 - Jan 2023

Remote / New York, NY

- Led end-to-end mixed-methods research for Fortune 500 clients.
- Facilitated a 3-day, 60-person workshop that turned C-suite priorities into product strategy.
- Led speculative futures work imagining 2122 to plan for water scarcity today.

Independent | Designer and Researcher
Jun 2020 - Aug 2021

- Research and design for Y Combinator companies, including Govly, Rally.Video, and Measured.

RaiseMe | UX Strategist
Dec 2017 - Jun 2020

San Francisco, CA

- Redesigned how 330+ college partners received enrollment data, replacing a manual export with automatic reports. Cut a weekly task from 15 minutes to 2 and helped retain 90%+ of revenue at risk.

Reed College | Assistant Dean of Admission
Jan 2015 - Nov 2017

Portland, OR

- Designed the Junior Scholars program from 0 to 1, then redesigned its outreach to grow applicants 8x (23 to 187).
- Presented the growth to senior leadership and secured $25,000 more in program funding from the President.

EDUCATION

Copenhagen Institute of Interaction Design (CIID) | Master's in Interaction Design
Sept 2024 - Aug 2025

- Living.fm: an AI radio host that notices what you're doing and comments on it.
- Bureau of Sanctioned Sketching (final project): a card game that gives adults permission to draw.
- Linee: a tactile timekeeper for shared homes, with no alarms.
- Disco Never Died: a code-made disco ball that pulses with the sound in the room.

Colby College | B.A. in Sociology
Sept 2010 - May 2014

SKILLS

Prototyping: physical computing, sensors, 3D printing, laser cutting, 3D modeling, Wizard-of-Oz, playtesting
Research: prototype diary studies, interviews, usability testing, workshop facilitation, synthesis
Tools: Arduino, Python, Processing, TouchDesigner, Resolume, Fusion 360, SolidWorks, Figma, Cursor, Claude Code